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Market Briefs **Pro**

Read less news

Good morning, Pro Briefers!

On July 18th, 2025, President Trump signed the Guiding and Establishing National Innovation for U.S. Stablecoins Act, aka the GENIUS act.

This is where we've identified a Broadmarket Shift - **Wait, not a Government shift?**

That's right, stablecoins are rapidly becoming a form of usable currency all over the world, and the U.S. is one of many nations adopting legislation.

Our Broadmarket Shift: The stablecoin revolution is ongoing, creating opportunities for stablecoin issuers, digital infrastructure companies, and early adopters all over the globe.

Stablecoin

[ˈstā-bəl-ˈkoin]

A cryptocurrency which has a value that is pegged, or tied, to that of another currency, commodity or financial instrument.



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Image [via](#) Investopedia

In this week's report, we're looking into stablecoins - what they are, how they're being used, and of course, the opportunities being created.

Let's get started.

BONUS CONTENT

Don't miss our exclusive interview: As part of your subscription, you get access to exclusive interviews and analyst insights.

To watch this week's content on desktop or mobile, [click here](#).

So...What's a Stablecoin?

Between the GENIUS Act, and the success of Circle's (CRCL) IPO (more on them later), if you've been watching the news, you've probably heard about stablecoins.

But these seemingly stable tokens have been around for a while.

To better understand stablecoins, we spoke to several experts. The first was Sid Powell, the CEO and founder of Maple Finance, an on-chain asset manager.

In English: They're an asset manager like BlackRock or Vanguard, but specialize in blockchain.

And currently, they have about \$2.9 billion in assets under management.

Sid gave a more practical definition of stablecoins:

"A digital asset, something you can transfer around a blockchain...the key thing is this digital asset has a value that is pegged one-to-one with the U.S. Dollar or other currency."

STABLECOINS vs. TRADITIONAL CRYPTOCURRENCIES

	Stablecoins	Traditional cryptocurrencies
Volatility	Extremely low	Can be extremely high
Monetary policy	Similar to fiat currencies or assets like precious metals	Determined by the blockchain protocol
Properties	Medium of exchange, unit of account and store of value	Varies. For example, Bitcoin is seen as a store of value, while other cryptocurrencies may be seen as a medium of exchange
Asset backing	Backed by assets in reserves or algorithmically	Not backed by any physical commodity or metal
Degree of authority	Most stablecoins are controlled by a central entity	Most cryptocurrencies aim to be decentralized

Data [via](#) Crypto Zombies

- One of the other defining factors of a stablecoin is that it must be backed by something redeemable - meaning you can trade it in for something, like dollars or gold.

Just one problem, if a stablecoin becomes “depegged” from what its valuation is tied to, all of a sudden, it’s not so stable.

- Depegging is when the value of a stablecoin becomes different than the value of whatever it’s tied to, such as the dollar.
- In 2022, Terra’s stablecoin (UST) depegged, wiping out over \$40 billion in market value in a day.

How does this happen? Sid helped shed some light on this, and there are really two big reasons depegging happens:

1. Poor asset backing: Some stablecoins are backed by assets **representing** currency, rather than the currency itself. Sometimes the assets aren't worth what they claim.
2. Liquidity: When a stablecoin issuer doesn't have enough liquidity to cover all of the coins that it issues.

These are some of the issues that legislation such as the GENIUS Act is seeking to fix, by applying things like FDIC insurance and holding requirements for stablecoin issuers.

Not just America: This shift has gone global, with many countries beating the U.S. to market with their stablecoin legislation.

MAJOR STABLECOIN REGULATIONS



U.S.
GENIUS Act



European Union
MiCA



Hong Kong
Stablecoins Bill



Bahrain
SIO Module



Brazil
Crypto & Digital Asset Framework

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Data via various news outlets

- The E.U. enacted the Markets in Crypto-Assets Regulation in December, 2024.
- Hong Kong passed the Stablecoin Bill on May 21st, 2025.
- Bahrain introduced stablecoin framework on July 4th, 2025.
- Brazil finalized its stablecoin framework on February 28th, 2025.

Governments around the world seem eager to get stablecoin regulation up and running.

A source close to Presidential advisor David Sacks claims this is because world governments are viewing stablecoins as a race.

And Trump believes that whichever government figures out a token economy will be “years ahead” of the rest of the world.

And as governments race to a stablecoin economy, companies have been racing as well.

Why? It’s going to take a lot of effort to get people to use stablecoins, and whether it’s tokens, digital infrastructure, or payment processing, everybody wants their product to be the standard.

IPOS

It's IPO Season

The recent hype around stablecoins really started with the IPO of Circle (CRCL), and it becoming the first stablecoin company that can be invested into on the open market.

Circle Internet Group (CRCL)

YTD Price → **210.50**
(578.06%)



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

- Circle is up over 570% since their IPO on June 4th, 2025.

Circle's coin is the second-largest stablecoin by market cap (behind Tether), and according to Sid, it's the most profitable company in history by number of employees.

But what makes Circle successful?

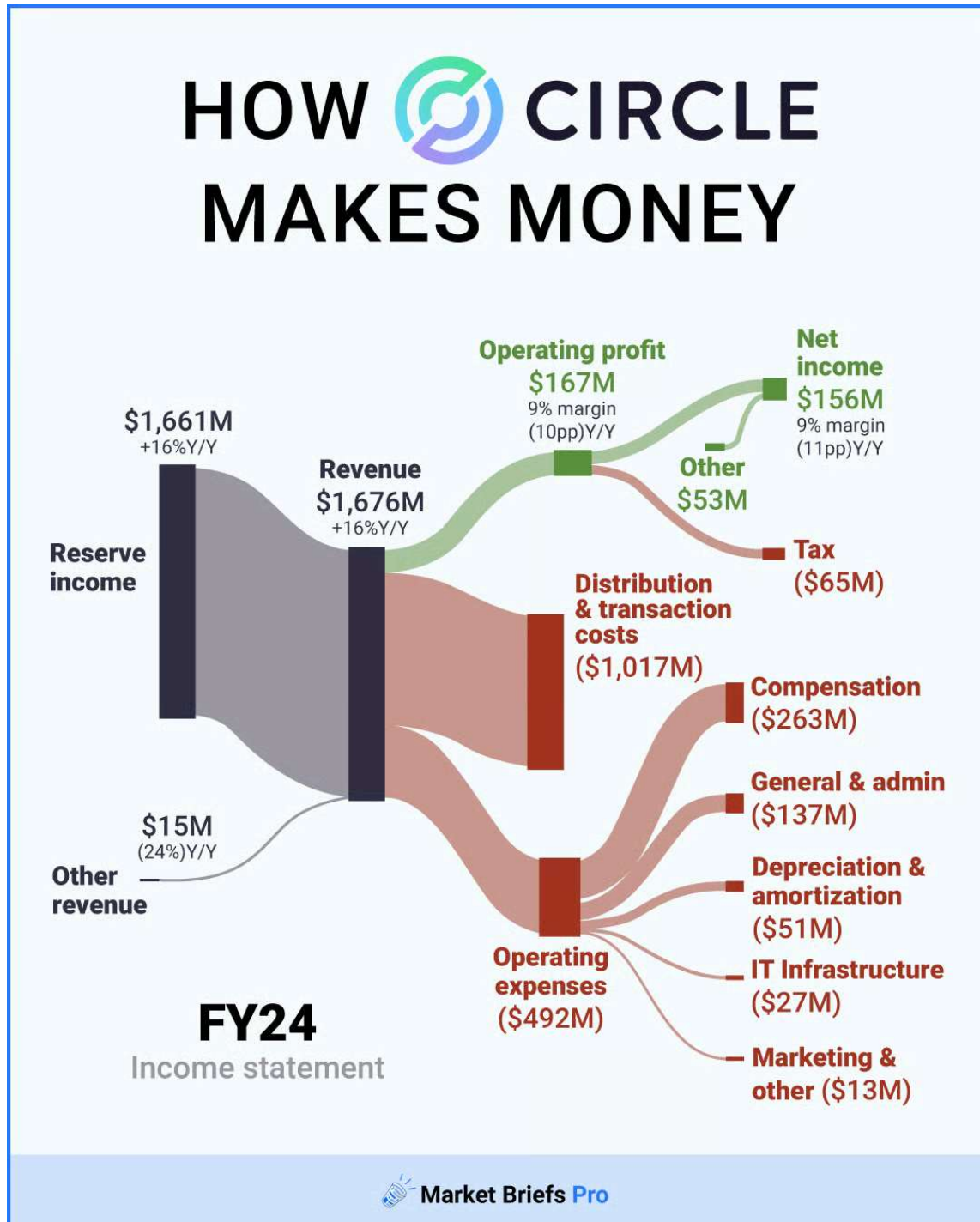
Circle's competitive advantage is really built on two things:

1. Regulatory compliance.
2. Transparency of assets.

Let's break it down:

First, while many cryptocurrencies embrace bending the rules (or working in loopholes), Circle has made regulatory compliance a major part of its business.

Circle holds money transmitter licenses in 49 states, D.C., Puerto Rico, and the equivalent in Singapore.



Data via [app economy insights](#)

The adherence to compliance positions Circle as a beneficiary to regulation changes and more mainstream stablecoins.

How? If stablecoins become a common form of payment, they still have to obey the law.

This means if your grocery store starts accepting stablecoins, Circle might very well be ready to go.

Circle also has transparent assets, and keeps open and strict liquidity when compared to other cryptocurrencies, even other stable coins.

- Circle requires a 1:1 backing for each of their coins issued.
- All of their backings are either in short-term U.S. treasuries (maturing in less than 90 days) or cash held at FDIC insured banks.

The company also publishes monthly reserve reports that are audited by a third party, showing proof of this backing.

What does all of this mean? Circle may **already be compliant** with new legislation..

You may be saying “Great, they’re a transparent business, but how do they make money?”

In this case, 98% of Circle’s revenue is from interest on their holdings (U.S. Treasuries, etc). They reported an interest-revenue of \$1.68 billion in 2024.

The big emphasis on Circle is because they are the only stablecoin company on the market, but not for long.

Gemini, distributor of the stablecoin GUSD, filed for an IPO in early June, in the wake of Circle’s success.



Image [via](#) Fortune

- Gemini was founded by the Winklevoss twins, who gained fame in the tech world by suing Mark Zuckerberg, claiming he had stolen their idea for Facebook.

Gemini's IPO is still pending SEC approval, but the company's coin follows similar, if not even stricter guidelines than Circle.

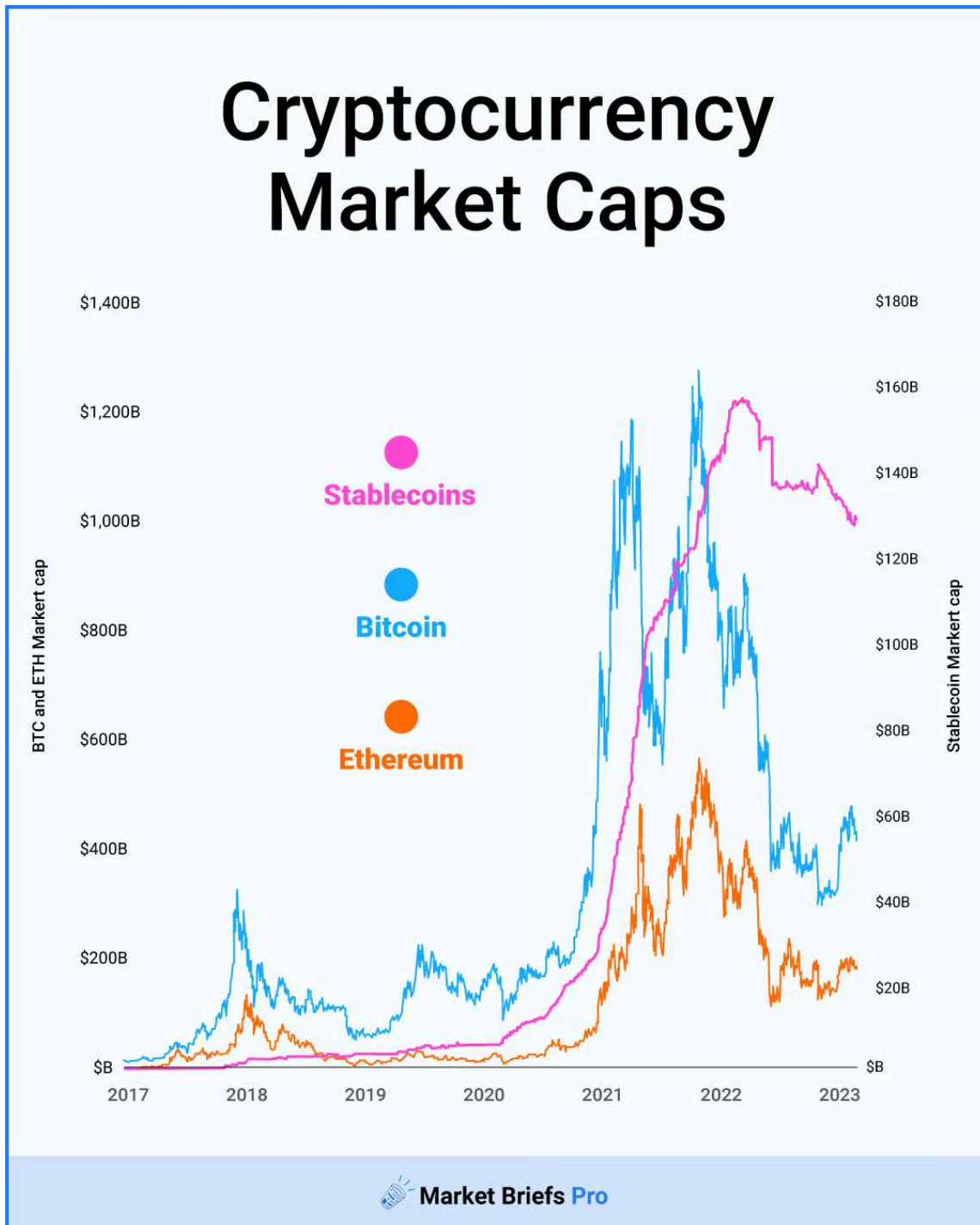
- Gemini operates under New York Department of Financial Services guidelines, which can be extremely strict.
- Their tech follows many strict federal guidelines and utilizes NASDAQ technology.

- Every coin is fully backed by FDIC-insured deposits.

If compliance, transparency, and strong backing is truly what makes Circle so appealing, Gemini could see the same, or even greater success with their IPO.

The recent success of stablecoins is also causing IPOs in other parts of the crypto ecosystem.

On July 14th the crypto asset manager Grayscale filed for an IPO.



Data [via](#) Grayscale

- Grayscale's own research department stated that stablecoins could be the "Holy Grail" of crypto.

It's no coincidence that Grayscale has been shifting its holdings into the stablecoin market, and its performance will depend those holdings.

If Grayscale's holdings are largely stablecoins, it should see strong growth with the stablecoin market.

They might also be able to capitalize on the stablecoin IPO hype, opening with a strong valuation.

Since Circle is the only stablecoin company available on the market, there are no stablecoin ETFs at this time, but that seems likely to change.

BANKS

Speaking of Stable Backings...

If what drives stablecoins is solid backings, strong liquidity, and regulation, you may be asking “wouldn't the best stablecoin issuers be banks?”

Our analysts asked Sid Powell the same question, and he confirmed that banks are “certainly” making an effort in stablecoins.

The “Big Four” American banks are all investing millions into stablecoin development.

Reminder - The “big four” banks are:

- JPMorgan Chase (JPM)
- Bank of America (BAC)
- Citigroup (C)
- Wells Fargo (WFC)

The furthest along in the stablecoin development is JPMorgan Chase.

It has a functioning stablecoin for internal use known as “JPMD” and is exploring options for making the coin public.

JPMorgan Chase & Co. (JPM)

5 Year Price → **285.66**
(185.63%)



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

- Up more than 185% in the last five years, JPMorgan Chase is the largest private bank in the U.S., with a market cap of \$793 billion.

JPMorgan Chase is so large, it's difficult for any single product to affect it.

Our analysts attended an exclusive webcast on July 16th, 2025, featuring JPMorgan Chase CEO Jamie Dimon.

In the webcast, Dimon publicly committed to their stablecoin development, although he believed stablecoin uses would be fairly niche.

Citigroup has also announced that it is considering issuing a stablecoin, and is developing token deposit services.

This means customers could deposit stablecoins into their accounts.

The Consortium - The most notable development regarding major banks and Stablecoins may be the recent joint venture.

It's been reported that all four major banks, as well as popular payment networks such as Zelle, are in talks to issue a joint stablecoin.



Data [via](#) The Wall Street Journal

What does this mean? This institutionally-backed coin would be issued by all of the major banks, and supported for all of their accounts and payment networks.

The massive amount of support for this stablecoin has the potential to make it the top stablecoin by market cap, essentially overnight.

It may also make it more difficult for other stablecoins to operate if various banks and payment programs only offer full support for the coin they distribute.

While not stablecoin-specific, there are many *many* ETFs that focus on major American banks, and feature all of the “big four.”

One of them is the Financial Select Sector SPDR Fund (XLF).



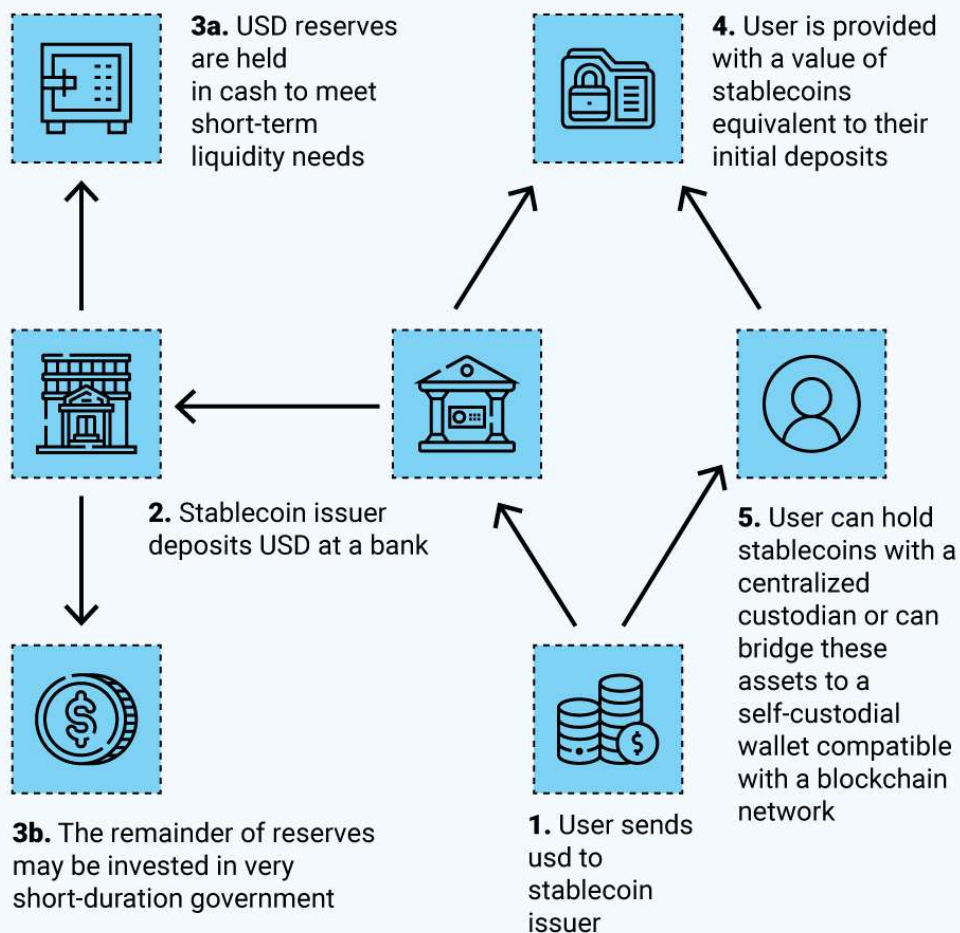
Transaction Touchpoints

Stablecoin adoption isn't something that can happen overnight.

Even with the GENIUS Act passing, coins need to be accepted by not only vendors, but their payment networks as well.

Put simply, if a company can't process a stablecoin transaction, it doesn't matter if your local store wants to use it.

Stablecoins for B2B Payments



- Stablecoin transactions require movement around the blockchain.

But some of the leaders in digital payments have gotten ahead of the game in stablecoins.

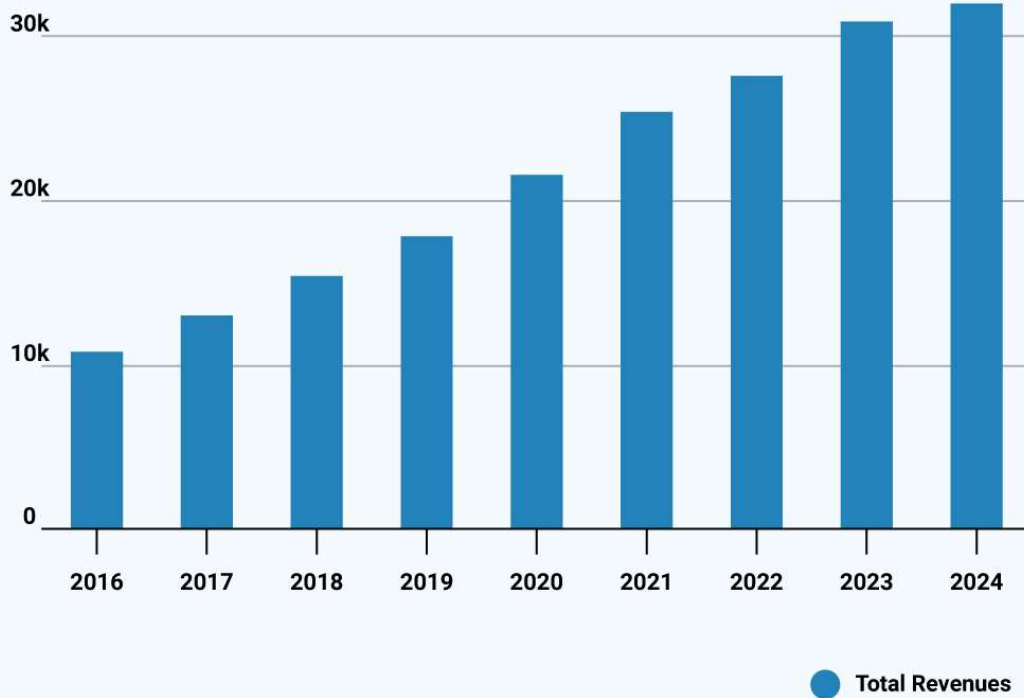
PayPal (PYPL) even has its own stablecoin, “PYUSD.”

Hoping that it can leverage existing market share, PayPal has been heavily pushing its stablecoin by:

- Increasing what blockchains it uses (Ethereum, Solana, and soon Arbitrum and Stellar).
- Partnering with Coinbase for zero-fee trades using PYUSD.
- Offering a 3.7% annual yield on account balances paid in PYUSD.

PayPal Holdings, Inc. Revenue (PYPL)

Revenue in millions



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Data [via](#) Company Reports

While PayPal doesn't disclose exactly how much of its business is wrapped up in PYUSD, it has issued around \$840 million worth of the stablecoin.

PayPal has a total annual revenue of nearly \$32 billion.

What does this mean? The stablecoin likely represents a small portion of the business.

But their aggressive marketing and offerings seem to show PayPal's confidence in the coin's potential.

And with investors losing confidence in PayPal, the company might be betting big on the stablecoin's success.

PayPal Holdings, Inc. (PYPL)

5 Year Price



72.97
(-57.03%)



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

- Shares of PayPal dropped significantly in 2022, and has been on a bear run ever since.
- Shares are down 57% in the last five years, and 14% YTD.

But with new regulations, PayPal could see a potential bear-to-bull transformation.

Not every digital payment company wants to issue a stablecoin, but all the major players are interested in getting involved.

American credit giants Visa (V) and Mastercard (MA) have both taken steps to ensure they aren't left behind by the stablecoin revolution.

These credit card companies are making sure their networks are capable of settling both stablecoin transactions with other crypto and USD.

They've also both looked into issuing credit cards that can operate in stablecoins.

Visa vs. Mastercard: Stablecoin Moves at a Glance

Company	What They're Doing	Why it Matters
 Visa	• Using USDC to settle payments on Ethereum and Solana • Letting fintech apps issue Visa cards linked to stablecoins • Partnered with Bridge to convert stablecoins to dollars at checkout	• Makes it possible to play with stablecoins like regular money • Helps crypto wallets connect to 150M+ stores that accept Visa
 Mastercard	• Built a "Multi-Token Network" to support stablecoins from partners like Paxos, Circle, Fiserv • Working on stablecoin-powered cards with crypto firms like OKX, MetaMask, and Kraken • Supports spending and receiving stablecoins across wallets, cards, and merchants	• Makes stablecoins usable for everyday payments and transfers • Lets people and businesses pay or get paid directly in stablecoins

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Data via various news outlets

Between the two, Mastercard seems to have a slight edge:

- Mastercard also offers end-to-end stablecoin support, creating partnerships so that every part of the transaction is within their software.

- The company joined the Paxos Global Dollar Network, giving them support for a large number of stablecoins.

Once again, it can be difficult to track the current revenue of stablecoin support for these credit card giants, but here's what we know:



Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

- Visa has processed over \$225 million in stablecoin transactions as of July, 2025.
- Mastercard has secured stablecoin support at over 150 million merchants across the globe.

With both companies being household names in the global market, Visa and Mastercard have an opportunity to become the standard for stablecoin transactions.

And without tying themselves to a specific coin (like PayPal with PYUSD), they can benefit regardless of which coins become dominant.

RISKS

The House Always Wins

U.S. stablecoin legislation has passed, but there's an elephant in the room.

The U.S. Government might issue a stablecoin.

If world governments begin to issue their own stablecoins, stablecoin issuers could find themselves out of business.

The government's ability to do this is one of the issues that delayed the House vote on the GENIUS Act.

If this seems farfetched, remember that prior to the U.S. dollar, the American economy used currencies issued by private banks, with different backings.

In English? This wouldn't be the first time this has happened.

Depending on regulations, there's also a scenario where stablecoins just don't offer enough of a benefit to get consumers using them.

Stablecoins tied to the U.S. Dollar also make money on interest, so the profits of these companies would change based on interest rates.

REVIEW

Stablecoins Seem Stable

The stablecoin revolution seems to be in full swing. Even with a minor delay in the House vote, the GENIUS Act has passed.

Expecting this, some of the biggest companies in the world are pouring millions of dollars into stablecoin support.

Will we all be using stablecoins overnight? **Probably not.**

But with the U.S., the EU, and other nations moving forward on stablecoins, it seems like we'll see some sort of stablecoin adoption in the near future.

If nothing else, it seems unlikely that the "big four" banks would be so willing to spend money on stablecoins if they didn't see it going somewhere.



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